

JShotz User Guide

Version 3.14.5

JShotz is a browser extension for Chrome, Edge, and Firefox that records a browsing flow as clean screenshots and exports PDF or Word documents. Each document shows the action time above its image and recorder attribution in the footer, with an optional table of API calls captured under each step. It's built for documenting test flows, support tickets, and step-by-step evidence of what happened in a browser session.

Before you begin

- Record ordinary web pages. Browsers protect internal pages such as chrome:// and extension store pages, so JShotz cannot inject its click and scroll capture helpers there.
- JShotz observes page fetch/XHR calls only during an API + Screenshot recording. Tab viewport and Screen/window modes leave site networking untouched.
- Keep the browser tab focused when using the whole-page Alt+Shift+J shortcut.
- Treat API + Screenshot recordings as sensitive evidence. Request URLs, payloads, and responses can contain credentials, personal data, or other information that should not be shared outside the intended audience.

1. Installing the extension

Chrome / Edge

- Unzip JShotz-3.14.5-chrome-edge.zip.
- Go to chrome://extensions (or edge://extensions).
- Turn on Developer mode (top-right toggle).
- Click Load unpacked and select the unzipped folder that contains manifest.json.
- If updating, remove or disable the old version first so only one JShotz copy is loaded.

Firefox

- Unzip JShotz-3.14.5-firefox.zip.
- Go to about:debugging#/runtime/this-firefox.
- Click Load Temporary Add-on and select the manifest.json inside the unzipped folder.
- Firefox 128+ is required.

Once loaded, pin the JShotz icon to your toolbar for easy access.

Updating JShotz

After reloading or updating the extension, refresh every tab that was already open before you record with it. Closing and reopening the target tab is the most reliable option. Chrome keeps the old page script alive until the tab reloads and may show Extension context invalidated in

the extension's error list. Delete that old error card after refreshing the tab; it does not indicate a problem with a newly opened or refreshed recording page.

2. The popup

Click the JShotz icon to open the popup. It has five parts:

- Status line - shows Idle, Recording - N screenshot(s), Paused - N screenshot(s), an interrupted-recording backup notice, or an error message.
- Memory estimate - while recording, shows estimated memory pressure, screen-buffer use, and the adaptive screen-prebuffer limit. JavaScript heap headroom appears when the browser exposes it; browser APIs do not reliably expose free physical system RAM.
- Settings - capture source and a compact Capture options list. Expand the list to check or clear behavior options. Settings lock once recording starts, except the capture source, which can be changed mid-recording.
- Actions - Start/Stop, Pause/Continue, Instant screenshot, Capture whole page, Capture Screen + DevTools, Save checkpoint, and Resume capture from folder.
- Screenshots list - a live list of what's been captured so far in the current session and checkboxes that choose the screenshots included in output, plus an optional 50-character note for each screenshot.

Folder access fallback

If a resumed capture folder no longer allows writes, JShotz keeps recording instead of dropping screenshots. New PNG files are saved in the normal Downloads session folder while the restored and new frames remain available for final documents. The popup changes its folder button to Reconnect capture folder; select the original folder to write subsequent PNGs and final documents there again. An empty selected folder is also valid: JShotz reconnects to it and confirms that the current flow is being captured there.

Open this popup from the browser toolbar after loading JShotz as an extension. Opening popup.html directly from its source folder cannot start a recording because browser extension APIs are unavailable there.

3. Capture source (modes)

Mode	What it captures	Notes
Tab viewport only	The visible area of the recorded tab	Default mode, works everywhere
API + Screenshot	Same as Tab, plus a table of intercepted fetch/XHR calls under each screenshot	Shows request URL, origin/referer, payload, and response; failed calls are highlighted
Screen / window (DevTools + taskbar)	A shared screen, window, or tab surface via the browser's own share picker	Automatically buffers settled visual changes, including opened API requests, detail tabs, and panel scrolling

You can switch modes without stopping the recording. Pick a different option from the dropdown at any time. Switching to Screen/window mode opens a small picker window - click Share in it and choose what to share. The tab being recorded is automatically brought to the front first, since the picker needs a real click.

If Screen/window mode's share source ends (you click "Stop sharing", or close the shared window), the recording automatically falls back to Tab-viewport captures rather than failing.

While Screen/window mode is active, JShotz watches the shared pixels because browser security does not expose the native DevTools DOM to extensions. A screenshot is buffered when an API request opens, the Headers, Payload, or Response view changes, or scrolling pauses. Buffered frames are processed in order, so image conversion and file writing do not cause quick DevTools updates to be lost. JShotz retains up to 100 accepted screen frames during a processing backlog and never evicts an earlier accepted frame to make room for a later one.

API mode begins collecting newly observed fetch and XHR calls while it is selected. It does not add network details retroactively to screenshots that were captured in another mode.

4. Settings

The five behavior settings are inside the collapsed Capture options checkable list. Its summary shows how many options are selected; expand the list to review or change individual options.

- Capture on every button click - automatically screenshot after clicks on buttons, links, checkboxes, and similar controls. Link destinations wait for their rendered page state before JShotz takes the screenshot. Its title and URL are read from that rendered page, and stale browser events are skipped rather than being attached to a later screen.
- Capture every 60% of a screen scrolled, and at the end - automatically screenshot as you scroll, roughly every 60% of a screenful (so consecutive shots overlap), plus one at the very bottom of the page.
- Whole-page shots for manual captures - see [Section 6].
- Save individual PNG files - save each screenshot as its own PNG in the session folder.
- Preselect PDF in output dialogs - starts each output dialog with PDF selected; you can choose PDF, Word, or both for every export.

During a recording, the behavior checkboxes are locked so the session stays consistent. The Capture source menu remains available, allowing you to switch modes without ending the session.

5. Starting, capturing, and stopping

- Open the tab you want to record, then click Start recording in the popup. JShotz displays a timestamped folder suggestion such as JShotz2026-09-2414-30-00-000. Keep it or enter your

own

evidence-folder name, then confirm Start recording. If JShotz has used that folder name before,

select Reuse existing folder, Create a new folder with timestamp appended, or Provide a new unique folder name. JShotz checks its own folder registry silently without opening the browser's Downloads notification.

- Use the page normally. Screenshots are taken automatically per your settings, and you can also trigger one manually at any time (see below).

JShotz retains the time each action occurred even when it waits for the page to render. The screenshot list, PDF/Word output, and session manifest keep steps in action order, with one settled frame for each normal automatic action.

- When a page you're recording opens a new tab (e.g. a sign-in redirect), JShotz follows it automatically - that tab is brought to the front and becomes part of the recording.

Switching back to the original tab (or to any other tab that flow has opened) resumes capturing from wherever you actually are. This also covers external or target="blank" links whose browser tab does not expose an opener relationship.

- To temporarily suspend screenshots without ending the session, click Pause recording.

The button changes to Continue recording. While paused, JShotz keeps the screenshot list, output selections, capture numbering, session folder, and tracked tabs or child windows.

Click

Continue recording to add subsequent screenshots to that same session.

If the browser restarts or crashes during a recording, JShotz ends that session safely rather

than attaching it to an arbitrary open tab. The popup reports the interruption, retains the stored screenshots, and offers Generate evidences. Start a new recording for a new flow, or use Resume capture from folder to continue a folder-backed flow.

- When you're done, click Stop recording. Use the Screenshots list to clear any frames you do not want in output. Select all starts checked and automatically clears when any individual screenshot is unchecked. This choice remains for the current recording if the popup

closes and is reopened. You'll then be asked whether to keep the files:

- Yes, keep - prompts for a custom file name and PDF, Word, or both. It then saves all PNGs, the manifest, and selected documents. Each document contains only the checked screenshots. Choose Save and stop (Ctrl+S) to finish without opening the file location and receive a saved-file toast, or Save, stop, and open file location (Ctrl+Alt+S) to reveal the browser-download folder after final output completes. While accepted captures are still being

processed, the popup displays The document is being created. Please wait.... JShotz drains queued captures into the final list before creating documents.

- Stop without document - keeps the captured PNGs, session manifest, and current interim PDF, but ends the recording without creating a final document.

- No, delete all - asks you to confirm, then removes everything from that session, including its interim PDF.

After a keep-files stop, the completed screenshot list stays available in the popup. Click Generate

evidences to choose a custom base name, select PDF, Word, or both, and create another document from

the checked screenshots. JShotz writes evidence documents into the same selected folder or Downloads

session directory used by that recording. If an output document with the requested name already exists,

JShotz appends the creation timestamp to make a new version instead of replacing it.

Evidence remains available until you start a new recording.

Manual capture options

Action	How	Notes
Instant screenshot	Press Alt+Shift+K, or click Instant screenshot	Captures one visible browser frame immediately
Whole-page capture	Press Alt+Shift+J while the page has focus, or click Capture whole page	Captures the whole page when direct capture is available; otherwise saves one visible frame
Capture shared screen	When screen sharing is live, click Capture shared screen, or press Alt+Shift+D	Captures the shared screen whether or not DevTools is open. The retained helper is temporarily activated and returned to standby if normal flow capture is in Tab or API mode

Manual captures are available only while recording is active and not paused.

Saving while continuing

Use Save checkpoint (Shift+Ctrl+S) to open a checkpoint save dialog without stopping the active recording. Enter a custom base name and select PDF, Word, or both. The screenshot list, numbering, output selection, and current session folder remain unchanged. A toast confirms whether the checkpoint save succeeded or failed.

Use Save and stop (Ctrl+S) to open the final save dialog. Once its selected documents are saved, JShotz ends the recording using the same keep-files behavior as Stop recording. A toast confirms the saved file name without opening its location.

Use Save, stop, and open file location (Ctrl+Alt+S) to open the same final save dialog. Once its selected documents are saved, JShotz ends the recording and opens the browser-download location. For a directly selected capture folder, browser security does not expose the folder's native path; JShotz opens Downloads instead.

The recorded JPEG frames are retained for output, regardless of the initial PDF preference, so a later dialog can create PDF, Word, or both. After a keep-files stop, Generate evidences uses those retained frames and the current checked screenshots to create additional documents.

Automatic interim backup

After screenshot 5 and every five screenshots after that, JShotz updates one JShotz-interim.pdf. It overwrites the existing file in the selected capture folder or the session's Downloads folder, so repeated backups do not create a growing set of files. The latest interim PDF remains available if the browser crashes, closes accidentally, or the recording stops without a document. A successful final PDF/Word save, or a successful post-stop Generate

evidences save, removes the interim PDF.

Resume capture from folder

Use this action when a browser or extension crash leaves a prior set of screenshots but the active recording cannot be recovered automatically:

- Open the page where the flow should continue.
- In the idle popup, click Resume capture from folder.
- Choose the exact earlier screenshot folder in the native folder dialog and grant read/write access.
- Click Start recording.

JShotz reloads the Screenshots list from that folder and captures the current page with the next sequence number. The earlier and new screenshots are selected for checkpoint and final Stop recording output. New PNGs, PDF/Word documents, and flow-manifest.json are written directly into the selected folder, and JShotz does not open a browser tab for this action.

If the selected folder has no previous PNG or JPEG screenshots, Start recording starts a new recording in that folder instead. It displays: No previous screenshots found in selected folder, JShotz is still capturing the current flows to the selected folder. Without selecting a resume folder, Start recording always creates a fresh session and Downloads folder after a stop or browser restart.

This workflow needs Chrome or Edge's native File System Access API. Firefox can record normally, but cannot resume into an arbitrary existing folder.

After a browser restart, the active recording has already ended safely. To continue a folder-backed flow, use Resume capture from folder and choose the same folder. Reconnect capture folder is for an active recording whose folder permission changes while the browser remains open.

Modal capture behavior

JShotz takes one screenshot when a modal opens. A fixed modal suppresses page scrolling captures behind it. Only a large modal with a genuinely scrollable body produces a modal-scrolled capture after substantial movement. Buttons, input edits, and committed dropdown selections inside a modal each create one settled screenshot. For a modal with no scrollbar, JShotz exports a compact image of the modal rather than duplicating the entire page. Cookie-consent banners and similar wide in-page consent overlays remain in the full viewport image, so the affected page and its banner appear together as one screenshot.

6. Full-page (whole-page) capture

When "Whole-page shots for manual captures" is enabled, the following explicit page controls capture the entire scrollable page instead of just the visible area when direct capture is available:

- Alt+Shift+J
- Capture whole page

Automatic captures (clicks, scrolling, field edits, and navigation) always remain one ordinary viewport shot, including narrow responsive layouts and DevTools Device Mode.

How it works, and what to expect:

- For a page whose content naturally extends below the viewport, Chromium rasterizes the document beyond its existing viewport. JShotz does not enlarge or reflow the page to render the shot.
- Long captures are split into sequential, bounded part N of M screenshots at one shared scale. Adjacent parts preserve the full page without a giant image and are exported as consecutive PDF pages.
- A progress bar appears in the popup and on the page while the capture runs. It is hidden before each screenshot and removed when capture completes.
- If direct capture is unavailable, including in Firefox, DevTools Device Mode, a page already attached to DevTools, or an app-shell page with an inner scroller, JShotz captures the current visible viewport once. It never scrolls the document or an inner pane to construct the image.
- Stopping a recording cancels an in-progress whole-page capture promptly. Its unfinished frame is discarded and cannot be added after the session stops.
- Chrome may show a "started debugging this browser" banner for an ordinary-document capture. This is a hard Chrome platform notice with no way to hide it; it disappears immediately after the shot.

7. Keyboard shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Alt+Shift+J	Whole-page capture (page must have focus)
Alt+Shift+K	Instant screenshot of the current browser view
Alt+Shift+D	Capture the retained shared-screen source; DevTools is included if visible
Shift+Ctrl+S	Open a named checkpoint save dialog and continue recording after saving
Ctrl+S	Open the final save dialog, save the chosen output, and stop recording without opening the file location
Ctrl+Alt+S	Open the final save dialog, save the chosen output, stop recording, and open its browser-download location

The extension-command shortcuts can be assigned at `chrome://extensions/shortcuts` (or the

Firefox equivalent). The Shift+Ctrl+S, Ctrl+S, and Ctrl+Alt+S flow controls are page shortcuts while a recording is active.

8. Output selection, notes, and saved files

Every capture starts selected for document output. Clear the checkbox beside an unwanted screenshot, or use Select all to restore the full set. For large sessions, the popup initially shows the 50 newest screenshots; use Show older screenshots to reveal earlier ones. The current selection is preserved while the session is active, even when the popup closes.

The same selection controls Save checkpoint, Save and stop, Save, stop, and open file location, Generate evidences, and final output created through Stop recording. Every output dialog accepts a custom base name and lets you choose PDF, Word, or both:

- With Save individual PNG files enabled, JShotz saves each captured screenshot separately.
- Stop without document always retains the captured files and session manifest but skips PDF and Word creation for that stop operation.
- The Preselect PDF in output dialogs preference changes only the initial dialog choice; output frames are retained so Word remains available later.
- Save, stop, and open file location (Ctrl+Alt+S) reveals the final browser-download output. A directly selected capture folder has no native path available to a browser extension, so JShotz opens Downloads instead.
- Generate evidences is available after a keep-files stop. It uses the same output folder as that stopped recording and appends a timestamp when the requested evidence filename already exists.

When resuming a selected folder, JShotz keeps PNG and document output available so the older and new screenshots stay together in that folder.

The generated PDF and Word document use the page title as the heading for each captured step. Add an optional note of up to 50 characters under a screenshot; it appears after that heading as [note] in both document formats. The action time appears immediately above the image and Captured by Jobin's Screenshots appears in the document footer; neither is overlaid on the captured page. API tables appear only on screenshots captured in API + Screenshot mode.

9. Troubleshooting

- After installing, reloading, or updating JShotz, refresh any target tab that was already open. This removes old injected page scripts and avoids an Extension context invalidated error.
- If the popup says JShotz is unavailable, reload the extension in the browser's extension page, then close and reopen the popup.
- If the Screen/window share picker is cancelled or the shared source closes, recording continues with Tab viewport captures. Select Screen/window again when you are ready to share a surface.

- During a whole-page capture, wait for the progress bar to complete before capturing again. Capture whole page is temporarily disabled while that work is in progress.
- If a page does not record clicks or scrolling, confirm that it is an ordinary website rather than a browser-protected page, then refresh the tab and start a new recording.
- If JShotz says Capture skipped: JShotz needs access to the current page, Chrome has revoked its temporary tab access, commonly after a cross-site redirect. Open the JShotz popup in the current tab, then continue recording. For automatic capture across websites, open JShotz's extension details and set Site access to On all sites. The skipped-capture detail stays in the final manifest's debugLog; it does not create a separate download.

8. Where your files go

Each recording creates a folder in your browser's default download location:

```
Downloads/  
Jshotz/  
JShotz<timestamp>/ (or the session folder name you entered)  
001<timestamp><label>.png  
002<timestamp><label>.png  
...  
JShotz-interim.pdf (updated after every fifth screenshot until final save)  
flow-manifest.json (list of every capture plus diagnostic debugLog)  
<custom-name>.pdf (when PDF is selected)  
<custom-name>.docx (when Word is selected)  
<custom-name>checkpoint.pdf / .docx (for checkpoint saves)  
<custom-name><timestamp>.pdf / .docx (when a same-named evidence document already exists)
```

Pausing does not create another folder. When you click Continue recording, new screenshots keep the next number and are written beside the screenshots already shown in the list.

When you use Resume capture from folder and then click Start recording, the selected existing folder becomes the working folder. JShotz writes the new PNGs, checkpoint and final PDF/Word documents, post-stop evidence documents, interim PDF, and updated flow-manifest.json there instead of creating a new Downloads session folder.

9. The debug log

JShotz keeps the newest 1,000 diagnostic lines in background extension storage while recording.

This prevents a separate diagnostic-file download or save prompt from interrupting pause, continue, capture, mode-switch, checkpoint-export, or error handling. When you keep a session, the same entries are included as debugLog in flow-manifest.json beside the screenshots.

The log lists capture triggers, mode, success/failure, timing, mode switches, recovery events, and errors. If you ever need help diagnosing an issue, share the relevant debugLog lines from the final manifest.

If you choose "delete all," no diagnostic file is downloaded. The in-progress log remains in

extension storage until you start a new recording.

10. Known limitations

- The "started debugging this browser" banner during whole-page captures cannot be hidden - this is a Chrome security notice, not a bug.
- When DevTools is open on the recorded tab, a manual whole-page request saves one visible frame rather than scrolling the page to assemble a long capture.
- Multi-tab and child-window following remains active while a session is paused and when the background service worker restarts.
- A horizontally-scrolling element on a page (e.g. a carousel) is captured exactly as it appears at the time - whole-page capture only extends vertically.
- Reloading or updating JShotz requires refreshing any already-open recording tabs before use.
- Resume capture from folder requires Chrome or Edge; Firefox does not provide writable native folder handles to extensions.

11. Getting help

If something isn't working as expected:

- Note the approximate time and what you were doing (which button, which page).
- Open flow-manifest.json from that session's folder and find the matching debugLog lines.
- Share the page URL (or a general description if it's private), the log excerpt, and - if relevant, the screenshot in question.